GMS WEEKLY
Your Source for Recycling News

June 19th, 2026
Week 25
Volume 282, Issue 1240

Highlights:

- **Peace signed.**
- **Brent collapses.**
- **Premium evaporates.**
- **Rains reign.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"I can't change the direction of the wind, but I can adjust my sails to always reach my destination."
- Jimmy Dean

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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PEACE SIGNED, RAINS REIGN

The war is over. The United States and Iran digitally signed an interim peace agreement this week, a US official confirming the memorandum has taken effect, with a formal signing in Switzerland set for Friday and the Strait of Hormuz reopening after more than one hundred days closed. President Trump announced the breakthrough from Air Force One en route to the G7 summit at Evian, authorising the strait to open and the US naval blockade to lift, and telling the world's shipowners, "Ships of the World, start your engines." Iran's Supreme National Security Council confirmed that all military operations, on all fronts, including Lebanon, would cease immediately and permanently. The sub-continent, which spent the entire quarter praying for exactly these ships, must now ask them to keep their engines idling until the monsoon lifts.

Brent crude has collapsed to approximately USD 78 per barrel, its lowest since late February and effectively the level at which the war began, erasing the entire premium that carried it to USD 126.41 on April 30. WTI trades near USD 75. The agreement removes sanctions on Iranian oil exports and clears the way for Saudi Arabia, the UAE and Iraq to restart millions of barrels of halted output. The International Energy Agency, which in Week 18 called the Hormuz closure "the largest supply disruption in history," now warns of a coming glut, projecting global supply to rise eight million barrels per day by 2027 against demand growth of two million. The forecast has travelled further than the oil.

Freight has continued to cool as the war premium drains from the dry bulk market. The Baltic Dry Index eased to 2,653 on June 17 from the June 1 peak of 3,222, with daily Capesize earnings falling to USD 35,162 from the USD 49,511 high of late May as the disrupted long-haul trades that inflated Capesize demand begin to normalise. Notably, Supramax and Handysize both firmed through the week, the geared segments most relevant to recycling candidate flow holding even as the headline index falls. The bunker-cost floor and the Capesize premium, the twin forces that kept older tonnage profitably trading through the war, are now deflating together and in earnest.

The currency response divided precisely along the fault line the conflict drew. The three Hormuz-exposed importers all strengthened or held: the Indian Rupee rallied to a five-week high near 94.60 as the collapse in oil prices improved its external balances, the Pakistani Rupee held its 2026 best near 278.28, and the Bangladeshi Taka held the floor of its band near 122.70. The Turkish Lira, alone, broke through 46 per dollar to a fresh record near 46.15, its slide driven by domestic structural inflation that the peace does nothing to address. The deal rescued the oil importers. It had nothing to say to Ankara.

And so the arc closes. Brent climbed past USD 126 and has returned to USD 78, roughly where it began; the barrel toured the war and came home. The strait the war closed has reopened, the blockade has lifted, and the premium that kept the world's ageing tonnage profitably at sea is evaporating from the fuel side and the freight side at once, which means the deferred wave of recycling candidates that eleven weeks of war held back is now, finally, being primed to break. It will break onto a sub-continent in the deep monsoon. The ships are free to sail toward a beach where the weather has just closed. Peace is signed. The rains reign. For the first time since February, the only thing standing between the yards and the tonnage is the sky.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 25 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

PEACE LANDS, RAINS HOLD

Band holds.

Bangladesh enters Week 25 with USD/BDT near the floor of its band at approximately 122.75, the level at which the Taka has now closed the entire war chapter without a single breach of the 122.74 to 123.18 range. The collapse in Brent toward USD 78, the broad easing of the dollar on the peace agreement, and the rupee's rally have all reinforced the band rather than tested it. Foreign exchange reserves near USD 34.12 billion remain ample, and with the global risk premium now draining out of every market, the central bank's management burden has fallen to its lightest since before February. Local steel plate prices held the BDT 65,000 level, with the USD equivalent near USD 530 per ton, the mill complex awaiting direction from the post-war scrap and billet markets rather than setting it.

Peace lands.

The end of the war reshapes Bangladesh's second-half setup more favourably than any single event of the year. The reopening of Hormuz and the collapse of the bunker-cost floor remove the central reason owners held ageing tonnage at sea through the conflict, which means the candidate pool that starved Chattogram for eleven weeks is now being primed to release. The interim peace agreement, the lifting of the US blockade, and the removal of sanctions on Iranian oil collectively point to a normalising freight and fuel environment through July and August. Chattogram enters that environment with the basin's strongest demand position intact: full plot capacity, a cleared Letter of Credit pipeline, and the region's most stable currency.

Rains hold.

The obstacle is now, simply, the sky. The Bay of Bengal monsoon governs the beaching calendar through August, regardless of how favourable the macro setup becomes, and the deferred tonnage wave, when it sails, will arrive at a coast that cannot beach at full capacity until the rains lift. The sequencing matters: if the candidates release through July as the war premium evaporates, and the monsoon eases into September, Chattogram could face the strongest post-monsoon demand-and-supply alignment in several years. The war that closed the strait could not fill the beach. The peace that reopened it cannot, for now, fill it either. But the reason has changed from a blockade to a season, and a season, unlike a war, keeps a schedule.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Andhika Paramesti	Bulker	9,369	USD 460/LDT ('as is' Sambu)

INDIA

RUPEE RALLIES, MONSOON RULES

Rupee rallies.

India is the single largest currency beneficiary of the peace. USD/INR rallied to a five-week high near 94.60, appreciating sharply from the 96.97 record of May 21 as Brent's collapse toward USD 78 fed directly into the external-account arithmetic of an economy that imports more than 80% of its crude. The MoU's finalisation over the weekend, the reopening of Hormuz, and the prospect of restored capital inflows combined to take the conflict premium out of the rupee in a way that seven weeks of intervention could not. India's May trade deficit had already narrowed slightly to USD 28.21 billion even as petroleum imports surged to USD 22.7 billion; the June figures, struck against USD 78 Brent rather than USD 107, will tell a materially better story.

Inflows return.

The rupee's rally is the cleanest expression yet of the war's end, but it is not unconditional. Foreign institutional investors were still net sellers in places through the week as global growth uncertainty lingered and as reports cautioned that shipping and energy flows may take weeks to fully normalise. The interim deal leaves the nuclear question and the durability of the Lebanon ceasefire unresolved, and a five-week-high rupee carries embedded expectations that the implementation must now meet. The Reserve Bank of India's June 5 inflow measures, the bond capital-gains tax removal among them, are now operating into a tailwind rather than a headwind. The currency has repriced the war's end. It now waits on the war's end to be delivered.

Monsoon rules.

Local steel plate prices at Alang softened through the week, moving from INR 38,000 at the start of the reporting period to INR 37,500 by June 19, after briefly firming to INR 38,300 mid-week. The USD equivalent eased from approximately USD 400 per ton to just under USD 397 per ton, as the post-war collapse in energy and scrap sentiment outweighed the support from a firmer rupee. India remains the lowest-priced sub-continent destination. The operational reality is unchanged by the diplomacy: the monsoon governs Alang's beaching calendar through August, and the candidate wave that the war's end is priming will arrive at a coast in the depths of the rains. Alang enters the post-war period with the basin's deepest yard capacity, a compliance footprint exceeding 110 valid Statements of Compliance, and, for the first time since February, a recovering currency and a deflating bunker floor working in its favour. The rains rule the third quarter's opening. The recovery rules what follows them.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

RUPEE HOLDS, PREMIUM FADES

Rupee holds.

Pakistan closes the war chapter as it spent it, as the basin's currency anchor. USD/PKR held near 278.28, sustaining the strongest level of 2026 and finishing the conflict as the only sub-continent currency to have appreciated against the dollar across its entire span. The State Bank's 100 basis point hike to 11.5%, disciplined reserve management, and resilient remittance inflows delivered a rupee that not only survived the most volatile quarter in years but strengthened through it. With Brent now near USD 78, the weekly oil import bill that Prime Minister Sharif quantified at USD 800 million at the height of the war is collapsing toward its pre-conflict level, removing the external-account pressure that drove the April CPI shock at its source.

Premium fades.

The peace, however, begins immediately to dismantle the specific advantage that made Gadani the basin's firmest market during the war. The Gulf proximity premium, which compounded structurally while Hormuz was closed and Gulf-region tonnage reassessed its positioning, now faces direct erosion as the strait reopens and routing economics normalise. The strategic clock that the Weekly first flagged three weeks ago is now running at full speed: each tanker that transits a reopened Hormuz, each barrel of restarted Gulf production, returns the maritime geography to its pre-war shape, in which Gadani competes on price and compliance like everyone else rather than on a wartime locational edge. The advantage was real. It was also, as the Weekly noted, circumstantial. The circumstance has just ended.

Position transitions.

Local steel plate prices at PKR 195,000 per ton held, with the USD equivalent near USD 700 per ton on the firm rupee, Gadani retaining the firmest absolute pricing in the basin for now. Three HKC-certified yards remain operational with further certifications in the pipeline, and the Ron at 21,502 LDT continues to work through the yard. Pakistan enters the post-war period from the strongest position any destination held during the conflict, but it enters a different competition: the wartime premium that lifted Gadani is fading, the deferred tonnage wave will route on price and compliance once the monsoon lifts, and the basin's competitive order will reset to its structural fundamentals. Pakistan consolidated the war better than anyone. The peace will measure what that consolidation is worth at normal tide.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

LIRA BREAKS 46, NICHE HOLDS

Turkey enters Week 25 with USD/TRY having broken through 46 per dollar to a fresh record near 46.15, having touched 46.44 intraday, the lira down approximately 17.2% over the past 12 months and roughly 7% year-to-date. The break is the clearest possible demonstration of the conflict's asymmetry: in the very week the war ended and every Hormuz-exposed currency in the basin firmed, the lira made a new low. Turkey's pressures are domestic and structural, the product of an inflation problem that long predates the war and that the peace does nothing to resolve. The Central Bank of Turkey's managed-depreciation framework continues to function as designed, the slide orderly, the level steadily worse.

Fresh record.

The May CPI at 32.61%, with the year-end forecast range suspended and the official target held at 24%, remains the operative read, and the central bank's policy rate stays at 37% against an effective 40% overnight lending rate. The one channel through which the peace genuinely helps Turkey is energy: a Brent price near USD 78 rather than USD 107 lowers the imported-inflation pulse that drove the April acceleration, and a sustained post-war oil environment is the most plausible disinflation tailwind the TCMB has had all year. It arrives, however, into an inflation structure so entrenched that even the largest favourable oil moves in a decade register as a marginal improvement rather than a turn.

Inflation governs.

At USD 268 to USD 290 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage, and the post-war landscape sharpens rather than softens that reality. The deferred wave of recycling candidates that the war's end is priming will route overwhelmingly to the sub-continent on the price differential once the monsoon lifts, and Aliaga's share of it will continue to be set by EU regulation and Basel Convention compliance rather than by price. Turkey occupied a different market throughout the entire war. It will occupy the same market throughout the peace. The conflict changed everything in the basin except Aliaga's position, which is precisely where it began.

Niche persists.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 25 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	460-465 / LDT	480-485 / LDT	490-495 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	420-425 / LDT	440-445 / LDT	450-455 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Softening**	268-270 / LDT	278-280 / LDT	288-290 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *69.16 million tons of steel recovered from ships recycled at Alang could help build the steel backbone of hundreds of large commercial port facilities, from container terminals and bulk cargo berths to quay walls, jetties, and deep-water marine infrastructure.*

- *72.55 million MT of CO_2 emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to removing Germany's entire transport-sector vehicle emissions for approximately six months.*

- *44.4 billion kWh of energy saved through ship recycling at Alang could power residential electricity demand across the Gulf region for approximately two months.*

IMPORTANT DATES

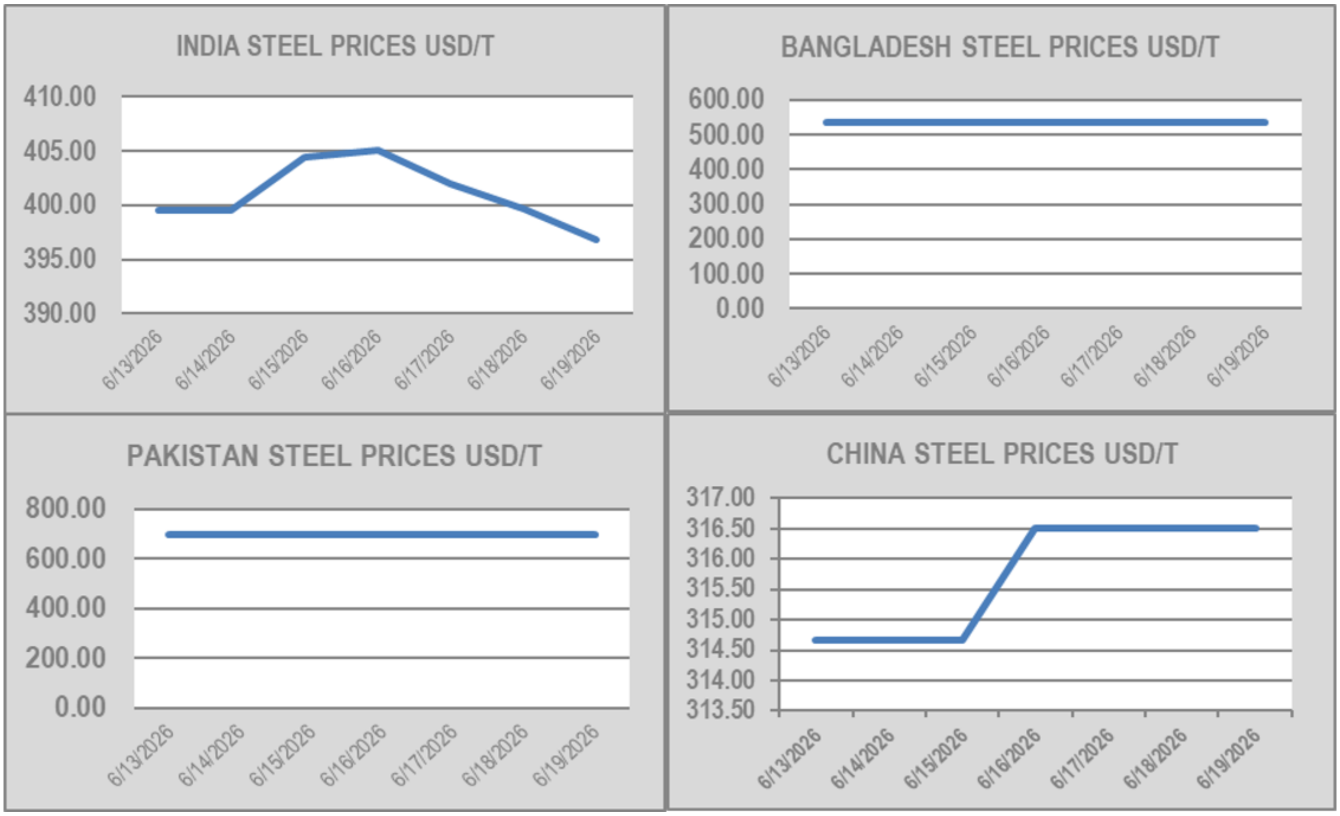
INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
June 26 – Muharram	June 27 – July 05 July 11 – July 20

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
June 26 – Ashura	June 30 – July 03 July 14 – July 17

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
June 26 – Muharram	July 15 - Democracy and National Unity Day

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
ALANG - Port Position as of June 19, 2026				
1	Mary	10,509	Passenger	Arrived June 18
2	Octans	41,478	Oil Tanker	*Delivered June 17*
3	Bigli	26,652	Container	*Delivered June 17*
4	Timon	27,063	Container	*Delivered June 14*
5	Grouse Arrow	11,059	General Cargo	*Delivered June 14*
6	Stolt Innovation	12,940	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered June 13*
7	Gala	6,378	RoRo	Arrived June 10
CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of June 19, 2026				
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Mai 1	1,844	Tanker	Arrived June 18
2	Xin Hai 18	1,543	General Cargo	Arrived June 17
3	Gas Crusader	1,526	Tanker	*Delivered June 16*
4	Kanishka	10,026	Bulk Carrier	*Delivered June 14*
GADANI - Port Position as of June 19, 2026				
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ron	21,502	Bulk Carrier	*Delivered June 12*

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
6/13/2026	399.54	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/14/2026	399.54	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/15/2026	404.39	38,300.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/16/2026	405.03	38,300.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/17/2026	401.99	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/18/2026	399.66	37,700.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/19/2026	396.83	37,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50



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